GLOBAL MOBILITY EXECUTIVE x GLOBAL TRAVEL EXECUTIVE

AMSTERDAM, OCTOBER 2026

# Reimagining the Future of Global Workforce Management

## Where Global Mobility meets Business Travel

What 52 organizations in one Amsterdam room revealed about business travel and international remote work. Every figure aggregated. No organization named.

POWERED BY CBIQ

CBIQ is the workforce intelligence platform built on contributions from Global Mobility, HR, Travel and workforce leaders worldwide. Room findings are benchmarked against the live CBIQ pool.

THE BENCHMARK AT A GLANCE

# Three numbers from one room

On October 8, 2026, GME and GTE brought together Global Mobility, travel, HR, and tax leaders in Amsterdam. Fifty-two organizations contributed structured data on how they govern business travel and international remote work, answering the most detailed instrument CBIQ has fielded on these two programs.

## 20 of 52

say nobody is clearly accountable for business travel compliance

## 15 of 52

enforce a day threshold. A further 17 apply one that is advisory only

## 18 of 37

supporting international remote work put the arrangement in a formal agreement

On several of the deepest governance questions, this room is the first population CBIQ has ever measured. Accountability for traveler compliance, tracking method, reporting on demand, threshold enforcement, remote work documentation, pay treatment, and tax cost allocation have never before been measured in the CBIQ pool at this depth. Those findings are presented as what they are: the market's first benchmark, set in Amsterdam.

# Not a small-program crowd

Of the 52 organizations in the room, 22 operate at 5,000 or more business trips a year. That is a heavier travel profile than the wider market.

**BUSINESS TRIPS PER YEAR · COUNT OF ORGANIZATIONS**




Throughout this paper the room is reported in counts. Market comparisons draw on the CBIQ intelligence pool, with the responding base stated against every figure.

**ORGANIZATIONS AT 5,000+ TRIPS A YEAR**

The room: 22 of 52, or 42 percent.
The global CBIQ pool: 38 percent (base 103).
Europe including the UK and Ireland: 37 percent (base 65).

The room skewed toward exactly the organizations for whom a governance failure is a volume problem, not an edge case.

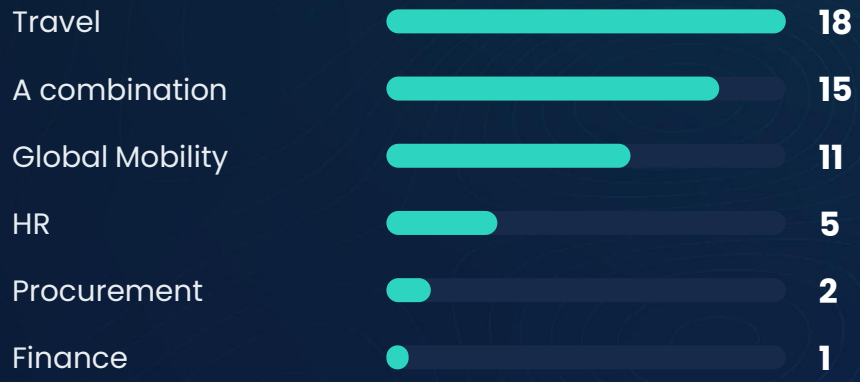
# 20 of 52 say nobody is accountable

Asked who is accountable when a business traveler creates a compliance obligation, nearly 2 in 5 organizations in the room could not name an owner.

### ACCOUNTABLE FOR TRAVELER COMPLIANCE




### WHO OWNS THE BUSINESS TRAVEL PROGRAM

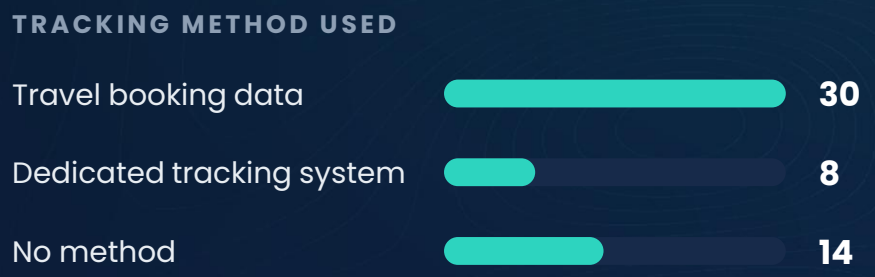



The wider market mirrors the room. Globally, Global Mobility owns the business travel program in just 18 percent of organizations (base 104), against Travel at 33 percent and a combination of functions at 27 percent. Across Europe including the UK, it is 20 percent (base 66). The function with the deepest understanding of cross-border compliance owns the program least often. Fragmented ownership is not a gap in the data. It is the operating model.

# The policy is written. The machinery is not.

42 of 52 organizations have a business travel policy, in line with 78 percent globally (base 112) and 76 percent across Europe including the UK (base 72). Only 20 systematically track the days that make the policy mean anything.




> The largest group, 30 organizations, relies on travel booking data, which captures the itinerary as booked, not the trip as traveled, and misses anything booked outside the tool. Only 8 of 52 use a dedicated tracking system.

Reporting capability follows the tracking gap, and the exposure question is the most revealing number in this paper.

### CAN PRODUCE TRAVELER REPORTING ON DEMAND




### COMPLIANCE EXPOSURE IN THE LAST TWO YEARS




More than half the room could not hand a regulator, an auditor, or their own CFO a clean answer tomorrow. For organizations where days go untracked and reporting takes significant effort, "not that we are aware of" is not reassurance.

### AMONG THE 8 WITH KNOWN EXPOSURE

Immigration or work authorization was the most common type, with 7 mentions, ahead of income tax (2), social security (1), and employment law (1). Half changed nothing afterward: 4 of 8 reported no resulting change to process or policy.

# 32 apply a day threshold. 15 enforce it.

An advisory threshold is a suggestion wearing a control's clothing. Taken together, 37 of 52 organizations either have no threshold or have one that no traveler is required to respect.

### DAY THRESHOLD APPLIED TO BUSINESS TRAVEL




### PRE-TRAVEL APPROVAL




Where thresholds do exist they are set conservatively. Of the 32 organizations with a threshold, 12 set it under 30 days, 8 at 30 days, 8 varying by country, and only 4 at 60 days or longer. The problem is not where the line is drawn. It is that the line is so rarely enforced.

# What leaders assess, and what they overlook

Pre-travel risk assessment in the room, counted across 52 organizations. Immigration is assessed almost universally. Employment law and data privacy are not.




The wider market ranks its challenges the same way. In the global pool, immigration risks (31) and tax risks (29) lead the list of business travel concerns. Base 114, multi-select.

**THE BLIND SPOT**

Data privacy is assessed by 6 of 52, and 6 organizations assess nothing at all before an employee travels.

# Table stakes, tightly capped

Support for international remote work in the room runs at 37 of 52, almost exactly the market rate: 71 percent across Europe including the UK (base 109) and 68 percent globally (base 181). IRW is no longer a differentiator.

### GOVERNANCE IN PLACE · OF THE 37 SUPPORTING IRW




### SHARE OF STATED CAPS SET AT 30 DAYS




Room: 17 of 21 stating a cap length. Market bases 43 (Europe) and 69 (global).

> The room has learned to keep arrangements short. Underneath the caps, the governance thins out fast.

# Pay does not change wherever they go

The five questions underneath the cap, counted across the 37 organizations that support international remote work. In the global pool, only 12 of 51 organizations have ever run a cost-benefit analysis of their IRW offering. The market built the benefit first and is still deciding whether to build the governance.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| PAY TREATMENT<br>of 37 | 26 | **unchanged regardless of location**<br>3 always adjust, 8 case by case |
| DOCUMENTATION<br>of 37 | 18 | **use a formal agreement**<br>15 an email or informal record, 4 nothing |
| TAX COST<br>of 37 | 9 | **say the employee bears it**<br>8 the company, 1 shared, 6 unclear, 13 do not permit liability |
| VOLUME<br>of 37 | 11 | **do not track how many arrangements they have**<br>Of those that do, 10 report more than 100 a year |
| APPROVAL SITS WITH<br>of 37 | 12 | **HR and 12 line managers**<br>Global Mobility in 8, and 4 require no formal approval |

# Five moves the data points to

For the leaders in the room, and the market reading over their shoulders.

**01 Name the owner.**
A program with 10,000 trips and no accountable function is governed by default, by whoever notices the problem last.

**02 Track travel as traveled, not as booked.**
Booking data misses trip changes, personal extensions, and off-tool bookings. The 30 of 52 relying on it measure intent, not exposure.

**03 Make the threshold binding.**
An advisory threshold protects nobody. If it cannot be enforced, the tracking gap is the real problem.

**04 Paper the remote work.**
Fifteen room organizations run international arrangements on an email. A formal agreement turns an exposure into a policy.

**05 Run the cost-benefit analysis.**
Only 12 of 51 organizations in the global pool have run one. Quantify what IRW costs and returns, and you can defend it.

METHODOLOGY

# How these figures were produced

## ROOM DATA

52 organizations contributing structured responses through GME x GTE Amsterdam registration, October 2026.

Room figures are reported as counts. Question bases vary where respondents did not complete every item and are stated where they differ from 52.

International remote work depth questions apply to the 37 organizations supporting IRW.

## MARKET DATA

CrossBorderIQ is the workforce intelligence platform built on contributions from Global Mobility, HR, Travel and workforce leaders worldwide..

Market figures are reported as percentages with the responding base stated against each figure. Regional classification follows organizational headquarters, not respondent location. Vendor organizations are excluded from all figures.

Several governance questions were fielded for the first time with this instrument. Where no prior market base exists, room findings are presented as a new benchmark and no market comparison is drawn. No contributing organization is named or identifiable in this paper.

GLOBAL MOBILITY EXECUTIVE x GLOBAL TRAVEL EXECUTIVE

THE BENCHMARK CONTINUES

# Every room adds to the pool. This one set the baseline.

The 52 organizations in Amsterdam are now part of the CBIQ benchmark. Contributors see how their own program compares, question by question, against the market they operate in.

EXPLORE THE BENCHMARKS

CBIQ

**cbiq.ai**

A GME x GTE white paper, powered by CBIQ.
Amsterdam, October 2026.